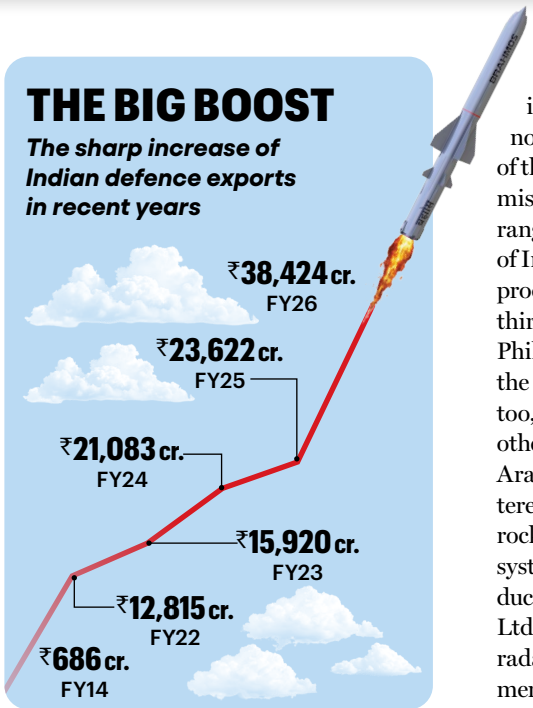


TOP DRAW
India's BrahMos missile has been exported to the Philippines and Vietnam. Indonesia is its third overseas buyer

THE BIG BOOST

The sharp increase of Indian defence exports in recent years



target. When he visited Jakarta in July, India and Indonesia announced agreements on the supply of the BrahMos supersonic cruise missile and the Astra beyond-visual-range (BVR) air-to-air missile—two of India's prominent indigenous products. Indonesia becomes the third overseas customer, after the Philippines and Vietnam, to procure the BrahMos. Astra's reputation, too, is spreading, with at least four other countries—Armenia, Saudi Arabia, Vietnam, Malaysia—interested in it. Pinaka multi-barrel rocket launchers, Akash air defence systems, Dornier 228 aircraft (produced by Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd), coastal surveillance systems, radars and electronic warfare equipment are also emerging as important components of India's export basket. Clearly, India's defence industry is graduating from selling individual pieces of equipment and ammunition to competing internationally with complete weapon systems—missiles, artillery, air defence equipment, naval platforms, radars, electronic warfare (EW) systems, aircraft and sophisticated counter-drone technologies.

The burgeoning exports can be attributed to indigenous research, competitive pricing, government-backed defence diplomacy and, increasingly, the operational record of Indian systems. The exemplary performance of BrahMos, Akash, Pinaka, counter-drone technology, EW and radar systems during Operation Sindoor against Pakistan in